

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 3 2
♥ J 9 7 4 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ 9 2

♠ K 10 9 8 6 5

♥ Q

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ 10 8 5 2

♦ 9 8 5 3

♣ A 10 8 7

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K 6

♦ K Q J

♣ J 5 4 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

discarding dummy's ♣K. That's a lot of winners you are wasting but you can afford it.

Only then can you afford to play a ♠. East can win the ♠A, but if he plays a ♣ dummy will be able to over-ruff West.

After you pull trumps you can drive out the ♦A and claim the contract.

As you see, trying even one round of trumps would have been fatal.

You had to get rid of dummy's singleton ♥ first - the fact that it was a winner should not affect your making the correct play.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 4♠ and you pass.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣9. East takes the ♣A, then returns the ♣7 on which West plays the ♣2.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3

Careful! Although it looks like only 3 losers you are in real danger of a ♣ ruff. It is almost certain that West has led a doubleton ♣ so if East can get the lead with either ♠A or ♦A they will get the ruff.

Fortunately your ♦s are solid and you do not need the ♥Q as a winner.

So before playing any trumps play ♥A K,

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 2
 ♥ Q J 10 3
 ♦ Q J 4
 ♣ A 7

♠ 5 3

♥ 7 6

♦ 10 5

♣ 9 8 6 5 4 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ A K 5

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ Q 10

♠ A 9 6

♥ 9 8 4 2

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K J

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
All Pass			
3♣ by South			

Many people play Jacoby Transfer convention. Not all of them play that an initial response of 2♠ asks partner to bid 3♣. You use that here and reply 3♣. Everybody passes.

What a terrible dummy! This shows why this method is a good addition to Jacoby Transfers.

South plays 3♣. West leads the ♥Q. East takes the ♥A K, then switches to the ♠Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = ? :: Total = 3 + ?

Instead of trying to estimate how many ♣ losers you may have, just tell yourself that you can only afford to lose one! Then you base your plan on that requirement.

You might as well win the ♠A. You need to play the trumps from dummy and the easiest way to get there is to play ♦A K, then ruff a ♦. Now play a ♣ from dummy and play what from your hand?

You may think it is a guess whether to play the ♣K or ♣J, but there is no guessing involved here. You must play the ♣J because East cannot possibly hold the ♣A. Just go back and look at the bidding again. The East hand failed to open the bidding in first seat. And since then you have seen the ♥A K and the ♠Q come out of the hand. That's 9 points and the ♣A would bring that total to 13. Since he passed it follows that he doesn't have the ♣A. Of course he might or might not have the ♣Q, you just have to hope for that card.

It's easy to forget the bidding once you have started playing a hand.

But good players don't forget, they use every bit of information they can get to help them make their contracts. That's why they make more contracts.

Board 5
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ Q 8 2
 ♥ J 6 4
 ♦ J 7 5
 ♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ K 9 7
 ♦ K 8 6 2
 ♣ A Q 5



♠ A K J
 ♥ A Q 3
 ♦ A 4 3
 ♣ K 10 4 2

♠ 10 9 6 3
 ♥ 10 8 5 2
 ♦ Q 10 9
 ♣ J 6

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South a 40% chance.			

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 20 points you are supposed to pass. With 21 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. The evaluations probably aren't that accurate, but at least you have an excuse to bid 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♣9. East plays the ♣J which you take with your ♣K.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

There are two places you might find your twelfth winner. You can finesse East for the ♠Q; this is a 50% chance. Or, the ♦s might split 3-3; this is about

If you try the ♠ finesse and it fails you will go down even if the ♦s are splitting 3-3.

If you play ♦A, ♦K then another ♦, a 4-2 ♦ split will defeat you even if the ♠Q was with East.

Two chances are always better than one. The way to take both chances is to duck a ♦ at trick 2. Win whatever the defenders play next and then test the ♦s. If they do split your last ♦ will be trick #12. But if they don't split you can still try the ♠ finesse.

Ducking the ♦ was the correct play - not just because it worked, but because it gave you the opportunity to try an alternate method if it didn't work.